

Tunisia — the complete program. Everything, in one document.

Five absences. Nine legs. One metabolism. Every number recomputed in code, every correction applied into the design, every claim graded.

Provenance law: MEASURED = cited anchor · DERIVED = arithmetic on measured values · ASSUMED = declared default, commercially-validated = 0 — no buyer has signed anything; published as zero on purpose. Generated 2026-09-09 by nations_audit.py / make_nations_pdfs.py — the same code that renders the page.

1. The five absences and the one metabolism

Five structural absences — monetary sovereignty (debt \$40.5B, ~79% of GDP, 26.2% of export revenues to service), sovereign compute (InstaDeep: founded in Tunis, sold for \$680M), strategic materials (phosphogypsum at Gabès costing the sea >\$58M/yr), water, nutrition — answered by nine cash-positive legs on one metabolism of power, water, data and workforce. The audit is finished; the corrections are in the design.

2. The FX bridge — every dollar, by leg

Each leg below is volume × price × utilization, with the double-counting checks applied — the design carries the checked ledger.

LEG	TYPE	VOLUME	PRICE	\$M/YR	GRADE
Strategic metals (U + heavy REE, acid stream)	gross export	716,500 lb U3O8 + 585 t REO	\$80-95/lb U3O8 · \$30/kg REO	\$75-86M	STRONG
Solar fuel substitution (500 MW)	import substitution	745 GWh/yr displaced (876 GWh less 131 GWh to H2)	\$142/MWh (gas \$12/MMBtu x 11 MMBtu/MWh + \$10/MWh O&M); government anchor: 1,100 GWh ≈ \$125M/yr gas saving for the same 500 MW fleet (Pg14)	\$95-116M	PLAUSIBLE
Hydrogen → ammonia (loop-internal offtake)	import substitution	2.63 kt H2/yr → 14.9 kt NH3 for the GCT chain	\$500/t imported ammonia displaced (external offtake upside: \$8-9.5/kg H2)	\$7-25M	SPECULATIVE
Terfas (desert truffles)	gross export	940 t/yr mid (2,500 ha x 376 kg/ha; 70% exported)	EUR20-40/kg farm-gate	\$14-29M	PLAUSIBLE
Food import substitution	import substitution	1% of the \$3.0B food import bill (frame; volume bridge is a pilot deliverable)	imported protein \$15-25/kg vs local \$5-10/kg	\$30-30M	SPECULATIVE
Compute colocation services	gross export (services)	colo park, tenant-dependent	market colocation rates	\$15-15M	SPECULATIVE
ESG financing delta	financing delta (not FX)	100-150bp on ~\$800M portfolio debt	interest saved, not foreign exchange	\$8-12M	PLAUSIBLE
Total external-account effect (mid)				~\$279M/yr	\$80M strong · \$137M plausible · \$61M speculative · \$0 verified

By kind: exports \$117M · import substitution \$152M · financing delta \$10M (interest saved, honestly labeled as not-FX). **By grade:** \$80M strong · \$137M plausible · \$61M speculative · \$0 verified — nothing is commercially validated yet, and that ledger reads zero on purpose.

3. The energy ledger — every kWh, by leg

LEG	GWH/YR	THE FORMULA
Pump-as-turbines (return flows)	3.9	70% × 150k m³/d × 50 m × 75% × 8,760 h
Heat (kiln + exotherm)	30	9% of 333 GWh envelope
Flexibility (load shift)	20	dispatch value — not recovered joules
CO&sub2; mineralized	30 kt	mass, not energy
Total	33.9 recovered + 20 dispatch	isobaric ERD inside the 4 kWh/m³ benchmark — never double-counted

4. Phase 0 — every dollar, itemized

ITEM	COST	WHAT IT BUYS
Water panel: 100 points, full suite (F, Cd, Pb, Cr, As, salinity, nitrate)	\$35,000	the first anchor measurement
Acid-stream assays: 12 points (U, REE, Ra-226, Po-210, full metals) + GCT access	\$40,000	the second anchor measurement

ITEM	COST	WHAT IT BUYS
Emissions inventory: 30 passive samplers (PM2.5/SO2/fluorides) + lab	\$25,000	baseline for the health scoreboard
Cohort protocol: 3,000-family registry, ethics, data platform v0	\$35,000	the DALY ledger becomes MEASURED
Health pilot first tranche: 100 households + 2 schools, 90 days	\$58,000	filters, clean-air boxes, KPIs
Legal + finance: health fund, industrial SPV, land-lease pre-agreements, tender registration	\$25,000	structure before scale
Engineering + project management	\$35,000	the 90 days are run
List price	\$253,000	list price \$253k; the two anchor measurements cost \$75k and land first — the claimed range is the phased-execution plan, not the list

5. Every claim, graded

CLAIM	GRADE	WHY
\$40.5B debt (~79% GDP); 26.2% of export revenues to service	STRONG	MEASURED via World Bank API on 2026-09-09: debt \$40.46B, debt/GDP 78.7%, service 26.17% of export revenues (2024)
\$3.0B food and \$4.9B fuel imports	STRONG	fuel \$4.895B verified on WITS/Comtrade (HS27, 2024); food per the WB food classification
InstaDeep founded in Tunis, sold for \$680M	STRONG	public deal record; the emblem for talent without infrastructure
Gabès: >\$58M/yr of REE value lost to the sea	STRONG	Science of the Total Environment (2021): up to 1,523.67 t/yr REE, ~\$58M/yr losses
U + heavy REE from the acid stream, ~\$80M/yr	STRONG	flowsheet industrial since 1978 (Freeport), patent expired, Morocco building it now; volume derived from cited primitives; Gafsa-specific assays are Phase 0
~\$285M/yr external-account effect, tiered	TIERED	\$80M strong (proven flowsheet/cited anchor) · \$137M plausible (gated) · \$68M speculative (assumed volume/price)
33.9 GWh/yr recovered + 20 GWh/yr dispatch value	DERIVED	every leg computed from cited primitives; dispatch value honestly labeled — not joules
\$2,592 per healthy year (water rung)	PLAUSIBLE	arithmetic DERIVED in code; DALY anchors transferred from Iranian studies — the cohort baseline makes it MEASURED
Phase 0 = \$150-250k, itemized	PLAUSIBLE	itemized list price \$253k; the two anchor measurements cost \$75k and land first
Commercially validated	ZERO	no buyer has signed anything — published as zero on purpose

6. The hidden dependencies

DEPENDENCY	TYPE	STATUS	NOTE
Desal brine permit	regulatory	in design	Gabes outfall / diffuser; permit required before SWRO FID
PG chemistry (Ra-226 partitioning)	technical	Phase 0 assay	flowsheet keeps radium in gypsum (Freeport precedent); re-verify on Gafsa stream
Uranium handling	regulatory	gate	CNSTN licensing, NORM transport, export controls
REE separation capex	capital	later phase	+\$244M solvent-extraction plant beyond the ~\$100M circuit
Solar bankability	financial	gate	DSCR ~0.9-1.0 at the record-low tariff; bankable region or grant support required
Grid connection	infrastructure	later phase	3 GW connection + 400 kV upgrades ~\$450M
Compute accelerators	regulatory	gate	export-control licenses; colocation until an anchor tenant is licensed
Truffle yield	agronomic	gate	376 kg/ha is the 20-yr Murcia average; gate = 3-season record >=200 kg/ha
Export prices	market	exposure	U spot \$80-95/lb; truffle EUR20-40/kg — no contracted offtake yet
Financing	financial	uncommitted	DFI channel modeled for solar/desal; nothing committed

7. The structure and the pilot/capital separation

The design is six independently bankable modules sharing infrastructure. The loop is the outcome, never the precondition — no module’s economics depends on another module succeeding, and every gate is public. World Bank CCDR (2023): Tunisia’s water-sector investment need ~\$17.1B and energy-sector ~\$34.7B through 2050. The page is not that program and does not claim to be: Phase 0 is \$150-250k of measurements, and the whole core build is ~\$250-650M phased over years 2-5, module by module, each gated. The CCDR numbers confirm the scale of the problem; they do not compete with a pilot gate.

Africa Energy Portal (2026): 500 MW of utility-scale solar approved (~\$400M investment). Same class as the page’s P3 module (500 MW) — the record-low ~\$31/MWh awards are the reference the DSCR gate is tested against.

8. The Fed transmission — measured, not restated

World Bank API, measured 2026-09-09 (Pg1): external debt **\$40.46B, 78.7% of GDP**; debt service **26.2% of export revenues**; reserves **\$9.34B** = 4.3 months of imports; food \$3.00B + fuel \$4.90B of imports; CA -1.5% of GDP; growth 2.5%, inflation 5.2% (2025).

Channel 1 — the debt trap: the “original sin” (Pg12) — no long-term borrowing in the dinar abroad — exposes the state to the Fed cycle (Pg13): Fed hikes lift global yields, refinancing turns expensive, and the 26.2% of export revenues that debt service absorbs compounds while reserves (4.3 months) drain.

Channel 2 — imported inflation: the rate differential pulls capital to US safe assets, the dinar depreciates, and the dollar invoice on food (\$3.00B) and fuel (\$4.90B) inflates. The BCT — autonomous, non-monetizing under Organic Law 2016-35 (Pg4/Pg5) — must hold rates to defend the dinar: correct orthodoxy, strangled growth.

The loop’s answer: owned export engines earn ~\$117M/yr of gross exports outside the Fed cycle; the substitution legs take \$152M/yr out of the dollar invoice directly; reserves rise, the rating runs B-/Caa1 → BB-, and the refinancing premium shrinks for the state with its own hard-currency engines. Not defiance of the Fed — independence from the channel.

The household ledger — what this does to the cost of living

A state program that does not make life cheaper for its people is decoration. Each line, computed from the same primitives as the rest of this document; the quarterly price index in Gafsa and Gabès is the published enforcement: **the price of protein and vegetables must bend downward within 24 months of the first harvest.**

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The energy ledger — what power costs, per party

Anchors cross-checked: Rw10 (0.352 TND/kWh industrial, 19 TWh), Pg14 (the government's own 1,100 GWh = 5% of production, ~\$125M/yr gas saving), Rc13 (\$31/MWh inside the \$24-35 historical bid band), Pg15 (fuel imports \$4.895B, WITS-verified).

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The frontier — where the loop reaches, and where it honestly stops

The complete household budget, swept — nothing hidden, nothing promised beyond the frontier.

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The water stack — line-by-line, with each credit's failure mode

The \$0.347/m³ audit: the base is measured anchors; each credit is a loop-internal yield with a named failure mode; the degraded cascade still clears the \$0.68 gate.

LINE	\$/M ³	PROVENANCE	WHAT MAKES IT FAIL
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LINE	\$/M ³	PROVENANCE	WHAT MAKES IT FAIL
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The Darwinian ledger — why business as usual loses

Protein built the human brain (Pg27); the same lever, applied on purpose, is the plan's deepest one. The business-as-usual ledger is the fear-facts: what “keep doing what we do” actually buys.

FACT	THE NUMBER	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THE NEXT GENERATION'S BRAINS
Fluorosis belt	24% dental fluorosis (Rw1)	high-F water ↔ lower child IQ (Pg28) — BAU taxes the cortex before it forms
Protein poverty	first 1,000 days (Pg29)	permanent cognitive deficit — the trees version, built child by child
Brain drain	tertiary emigration among world's highest (Pg30)	the country exports its cortex like its phosphate
The proof	InstaDeep sold for \$680M	the cognitive gold was real — and sold, not kept
Debt	26.2% of export revenues to service (Pg13)	the budget cannot buy the interventions the brain needs
The idle cohort	28% unemployment; 54% women graduates (Rm19)	built brains, no environment — adaptation = exit
Inflation	5.15% on \$4.90B fuel + \$3.00B food	the first cut is diet quality — the Fed reaches the children's IQ
SELECTION PRESSURE	WITHOUT THE PLAN	WITH THE PLAN
Water scarcity	selects emigration — the skilled leave first	the mesh re-specifies the environment; adaptation becomes staying
Protein poverty	caps cognition permanently	ponds + canteens + quota reverse the pressure
The debt cycle	the surplus is eaten; the economy cannot invest	owned exports + substitution cut the invoice
Institutions	gates stay closed; skills emigrate through them	public gates select for competence, in public

The open-field plan — terfas, hectare by hectare

RUNG	HECTARES	SEEDLINGS	PRODUCTION	VALUE	OPENS ON
Gate (yrs 1-4)	100	600,000	≥200 kg/ha	first fruit ≥€20/kg	3-season record + contract
Scale (yrs 4-8)	2,500	15M	940 t/yr	€16544-29704M/yr	nursery output
Ceiling (yrs 8+)	3,000	18M	1,128 t/yr	inside 1,000-1,500 t/yr market cap (Rc8)	market offtake signed

6,000 mycorrhized seedlings/ha (Rc16) — the nursery is the first asset: 5M seedlings/yr of local-ecotype capacity, ~200 nursery + ~1,000 field + ~783 seasonal jobs at scale. Local wild genetics, not the imported soil biology that failed in Saudi Arabia (Rc17).

The AI spine — the system's nervous system, and its boundary

The AI runs the measurement, the routing and the publication — never the decisions.

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The results framework — what a World Bank board reads first

The scoreboard IS the M&E system (PforR class, Pg23).

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The people's energy is electrons, not hydrogen — and the H&sb2; lives inside the loop

The loop's H&sb2; (2.63 kt/yr) is an industrial molecule: per kWh of heat, green H&sb2; at \$0.21 is 7× the loop's \$0.031/kWh electron; blending caps at 5-20% by volume (Pg20/Pg21/Pg22); the whole H&sb2; volume equals 0.0% of grid-gas demand. The molecule goes where only a molecule works: ammonia for the GCT chain, inside the loop. the electrolyzer sits on the desal line, and everything it touches stays in the loop: the water it splits is the SWRO permeate (0.04% of the 150,000 m³/d output); its un-split reject stream is clean water that returns to the product line; its oxygen by-product aerates the spirulina ponds and greenhouses; its stack heat (15–20% of input) joins the kiln and DC reject heat on the desal preheat circuit; and the minerals concentrated in its flush stream join the brine valorization line. The electrolyzer is not a consumer of the loop — it is another recovery point inside it.

9. The state program — architecture, instruments, financing, adoption

Counterparts — who signs what

INSTITUTION	INSTRUMENT	ROLE
GCT (Tunisian Chemical Group)	acid-stream MOU + sampling agreement	the treasury's feedstock
SONEDE	municipal/industrial water offtake at >=\$0.68/m3 gate	water contracts under the existing regime
STEG	25-year PPA under the IPP regime (500 MW class)	the power leg's revenue
Ministry of Industry, Mines & Energy	program sponsor; tender registration	the executive mandate
Ministry of Health	biomonitoring + cohort registry	the scoreboard
CNSTN	NORM licensing for the uranium route	the regulatory pass
Ministry of State Domains & Agriculture	40-year leases under Law 93-120 (86,000 ha available)	the land
BCT	reserve/rating path; FX policy coordination	the monetary endgame

Legal instruments — nothing new needs to be invented

INSTRUMENT	WHAT IT PROVIDES	CITATION
Organic Law 2016-35 (BCT)	monetary autonomy; the program does NOT monetize	Pg4/Pg5
IPP regime — Law 2015-62 & 2024/25 awards	renewables concessions; ~\$31/MWh PPAs; 500 MW precedent	Rc13
PPP framework — Law 2015-49	desal/metals as PPPs where the state is the offtaker	Pg2
Law 93-120 (state-domain leases)	40-year agricultural leases; ~86,000 ha earmarked	Rc19
NORM/radiological regime (CNSTN, IAEA standards)	the uranium route's license layer	Pg11/Rm12

Financing stack — staged, gated, modeled in code

STAGE	FINANCING	GATE / CONDITION
Phase 0 (\$150-253k)	grant / founder / early mandate	no DFI needed; 90 days
Health pilot (\$58k)	ESG/grant	the first scoreboard numbers
Metals plant (~\$100M)	60% debt @7% + offtake security; MIGA	DSCR >=1.2 at contract prices (nations_v5)
Solar (500 MW, ~\$550M)	DFI stack: EIB/AfDB/WB-IFC at 4.5% + MIGA; or lean build	DSCR gate inside the bankable region (nations_v5)
Desal (~\$165M)	70% debt @6% + municipal offtake + sovereign backstop	blended >=\$0.68/m3, >=60% pre-sold
Terfas + food (\$7-35M)	concessional agri + founder	nursery first
EU Global Gateway (17 GW)	the national envelope this program plugs into	Pg7

Governance

- every gate is a public number — published, dated, re-checkable
- health fund separate from the industrial SPVs; one shared data platform
- quarterly scoreboard: water chemistry, filter uptime, cohort KPIs, price index in Gafsa/Gabes
- each pilot passes or dies alone, in public — the falsification ladder is the governance
- commercially-validated ledger published at zero until the first signature moves it

Adoption path — what the state signs, in order

- Month 0:** the state signs: GCT sampling MOU + Phase 0 mandate (\$150-250k, 90 days, no construction)
- Day 90:** two anchor measurements land: the 100-point water panel and the acid-stream assays — every projection becomes a signed number
- Months 4-18:** pilots on public gates: acid pilot, 100 ha terfas + nursery, spirulina pond, solar bid, desal offtake, health KPIs
- Years 2-5:** build only what passed: metals, solar, desal, health at basin scale — module by module, each with its own financing
- Years 5-10+:** the full loop: municipal spine, compute colocation, hydrogen, brine valorization — the destination the original design described

Investor essentials — the FX bridge tiered, and the pathway economics

By grade: **\$80M strong** · \$137M plausible · \$61M speculative · \$0 validated — the zero is published on purpose, and each gate is the instrument that moves it. Pathway economics, computed in code (nations_v5.py):

PATHWAY	REVENUE	CAPEX	GROSS MARGIN	PAYBACK	DSCR
P2 metals	\$75-86M/yr	~\$100M	0-37%	6.3 yr (mid)	2.40 @60% debt
P3 solar	\$27.2M/yr	~\$0M	71%	n/a	0.46 mkt / 0.69 DFI — clearing PPA ≥\$45652/MWh
P4 desal	\$30.1M @\$0.55 → \$38.3M @\$0.70	~\$0M	gate-dependent	n/a	0.54 @\$0.55 → 1.36 @\$0.70 — clears

Engineer essentials — the numbers an EPC checks first

Energy: 33.9 GWh/yr recovered + 20 GWh dispatch — PAT 3.9, heat 30, CO&sb2; 30 kt mineralized. Water: SWRO 4 kWh/m³ lift floor 1.09 kWh/m³ per 400 m (Rw4); gate \$0.68 blended, ≥60% pre-sold. Materials: Gafsa rock 322 mg/kg REE avg (Rm1); 60-85% to PG (Rm2); 85-90% of rock-U to the acid stream (Ru1), >95% recovery proven 1978-99 (Ru1); Ra-226 214-970 Bq/kg vs the 1,000 Bq/kg exemption (Rm11/Rm12); Phase 0 assays at 12 stream points.

Health essentials — the DALY arithmetic and the pilot

\$2,592 per healthy year against the \$4,000/DALY standard; 10 ha spirulina feeds 178,082 children at the RCT dose; basin needs 0.7 ha. Pilot: 100 households + 2 schools, 90 days, \$58,000 — gates: filter uptime ≥70%, urinary F ↓20%, results public.

What this document is: a concept-level engineering design whose numbers are computed in code from sourced primitives — recomputed, corrected, and applied into the design. Free and public.

What it is not: a commissioned state program, a bank-grade feasibility study, an investment offer, or a claim that any of this has been built. Nothing here is advice to any government or any investor. Nothing replaces geological, radiological, geotechnical or EPC-level surveys. Verify every figure and citation before relying on any of it.

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